

James Joseph Sylvester
Collected Mathematical Papers, Vol. I
New work: book pp. 76–90

15.

ON A LINEAR METHOD OF ELIMINATING BETWEEN DOUBLE, TREBLE, AND OTHER SYSTEMS OF ALGEBRAIC EQUATIONS

[*Philosophical Magazine, XVIII. (1841), pp. 425-435*]

CONTINUATION

p. 76

r and r' are termed the indices of augmentation belonging to U , s and s' the same belonging to V .

Finally, it will be useful hereafter to call the given polynomials U and V themselves the proposees, and the given equations which assert their nullity, the propositive equations, or, briefly, the propositives.

Now as many augmentees of either proposee can be formed as there are ways of stowing away between two lockers (vacancies admissible) a number of things equal to the index of the other¹; hence we shall have n augmentees of U , and m of V : thus there will be $m + n$ augmentatives each of the degree $m + n - 1$, and the number of arguments is clearly $m + n$ also, so that they can be eliminated linearly, and the final derivee thus found, containing $m + n$ letters (properly aggregated) in each term, will be in its prime form, that is, incapable of further reduction, and void of irrelevant factors.

It is worthy of remark, that the final derivee obtained by arranging in square battalion the prefixes of the augmentees, permuting the rows or columns, and reading off diagonal products, affected each with the proper sign (according to the well known rule of Duality), will not only be free from factorial irrelevancy, but also of linear redundancy, which latter term I use to signify the reappearance of the same combination of prefixes, sometimes with positive and sometimes with negative signs: furthermore, it follows obviously from the nature of the process that no numerical quantity in the final derivee will be greater than the higher of the indices of the two given polynomials.

PART II. TERNARY SYSTEMS.

CASE A. INDICES ALL EQUAL.

Method 1.

¹“Tot augmenta utriusvis ex æquationibus propositis formari possunt quot modi sint inter duo receptacula (utriusvis vel ambobus omnino vacare licet) rerum, quarum numerus indicem alterius æquat, distributionem faciendi.”

Let there be now three proposees, U, V, W , integer complete homogeneous functions of x, y, z , each of the degree n : let

$$r + r' + r'' = n - 1, \quad s + s' + s'' = n - 1, \quad t + t' + t'' = n - 1,$$

$$x^r y^{r'} z^{r''} U, \quad x^s y^{s'} z^{s''} V, \quad x^t y^{t'} z^{t''} W,$$

will, as above, be called the augmentees of U, V, W , and every other part of the notation previously described is to be preserved.

p. 77

Suppose now

$$U = 0, \quad V = 0, \quad W = 0,$$

we shall have as many augmentative equations formed from each proposee as there are ways of stowing away n things between three lockers (vacancies admissible)², that is, $\frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ of each kind; in all, therefore, $3\frac{n(n+1)}{2}$, and every one of these will be of the degree $2n - 1$, so that the number of arguments to be eliminated is equal to the number of ways of stowing away $2n - 1$ things between three lockers (empty ones counting), that is

$$\frac{2n(2n+1)}{2}.$$

As yet, then, we have not *enough* equations for eliminating these linearly.

Make, however,

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 1,$$

and write

$$U = x^\alpha F + y^\beta F' + z^\gamma F'' = 0,$$

$$V = x^\alpha G + y^\beta G' + z^\gamma G'' = 0,$$

$$W = x^\alpha H + y^\beta H' + z^\gamma H'' = 0,$$

it will always be possible to make the multipliers of $x^\alpha, y^\beta, z^\gamma$ integer functions: for if we look to any argument in U, V , or W , it is of the form $x^a y^b z^c$, and one of the letters a, b, c must be *not less* than its correspondent α, β, γ , for otherwise $a + b + c$ would be not greater than $\alpha + \beta + \gamma - 3$, that is, n would be not greater than $(n + 1) - 3$, or $n - 2$, which is absurd: if now any one, as a , be equal to or greater than α , it may be made to supply an integer part to the multiplier of x^α .

Here it may be asked what is to be done with such terms as $Kx^a y^b z^c$, when two letters a, b are each not less than their correspondents α, β : the answer is, such terms may be made to enter under the multiplier of x^α , or of y^β , or to supply a part to both in any proportion at pleasure³.

²See for Latin translation the preceding note.

³The prefixes of any such terms (say K) may be conceived as made up of two parts, an arbitrary constant, as e and $(K - e)$; e will disappear spontaneously from the final derivee.

From the equations above we get, by linear elimination,

$$FG'H'' + GH'F'' + HF'G'' - GF'H'' - HG'F'' - FH'G'' = 0.$$

This may be denoted thus: $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma) = 0$, which equation I call a secondary derivative, and the left side of it a secondary derivate; α, β, γ may likewise be termed the indices of derivation (as r, s, t , &c. are of augmentation).

Now since $\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 1$, it is clear that the index of $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ is always $n + n + n - (n + 1)$; that is, $2n - 1$. p. 78

1st. Let any two of the indices of derivation be taken zero, then it is easily seen that all the terms in $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ vanish, and consequently the secondary derivative equations obtained upon this hypothesis become mere identities, and are of no use.

2nd. Let any *one* of them become zero.

It is manifest, from the doctrine of simple equations, that $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ may be made equal to

$$\{\lambda U + \mu V + \nu W\} \frac{1}{x^\alpha},$$

or

$$\{\lambda' U + \mu' V + \nu' W\} \frac{1}{y^\beta},$$

or

$$\{\lambda'' U + \mu'' V + \nu'' W\} \frac{1}{z^\gamma},$$

upon the understanding that

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda &= G'H'' - G''H', & \mu &= H'F'' - H''F', & \nu &= F'G'' - F''G', \\ \lambda' &= G''H - GH'', & \mu' &= H''F - HF'', & \nu' &= F''G - FG'', \\ \lambda'' &= GH' - G'H, & \mu'' &= HF' - H'F, & \nu'' &= FG' - F'G. \end{aligned}$$

The three rows of coefficients will be respectively of the degrees

$$(n - \beta) + (n - \gamma), \quad (n - \gamma) + (n - \alpha), \quad (n - \alpha) + (n - \beta).$$

Thus if any one of the indices α, β, γ be zero, $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ becomes identical with $\lambda'U + \mu'V + \nu'W$, where the multipliers of U, V, W are of $2n - (\alpha + \beta + \gamma)$ dimensions, that is of $(n - 1)$ dimensions, and may accordingly be put under the form

$$\Sigma A x^r y^{r'} z^{r''} U + \Sigma B x^s y^{s'} z^{s''} V + \Sigma C x^t y^{t'} z^{t''} W,$$

that is to say, becomes a *linear function* of the augmentatives, and therefore if combined with them in the process of linear elimination would give rise to the identity $0 = 0$.

Hence we must reject all such secondary derivatives as have zero for one of the indices of derivation. But all others, it may be shown, will be *linearly*

independent of one another, and of the augmentees previously found. Hence, besides $3\frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ equations of augment of the degree $2n-1$, we shall have of the same degree so many equations of derivation as there are ways of stowing away between three lockers $(n+1)$ things, under the condition that no locker shall ever be left empty, that is $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$ ⁴.

Thus, then, in all we have

$$\frac{n(n-1)}{2} + 3\frac{n(n+1)}{2} = \frac{2n(2n+1)}{2}$$

equations, which is exactly equal to the number of arguments to be eliminated. Hence

p. 79

the final derivee can be obtained by the usual explicit rule of permutation, and moreover will be *its lowest form*, for it will contain in each term $\frac{n(n+1)}{2}$ prefixes belonging to the augmentatives of U , and a like number pertaining to those of V and of W , as well as $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$ belonging to the secondary derivatives, each prefix in any one of which is trilateral, containing a prefix drawn out of those belonging to each of the proposees.

Thus every member containing $n\frac{n+1}{2} + n\frac{n-1}{2}$, that is n^2 of the original prefixes belonging to U, V, W , singly and respectively, the final derivee evolved by this process will be in its lowest terms; as was to be proved.

CASE A. INDICES ALL EQUAL.

Method 2.

It is remarkable that we may vary the method just given by making

$$r + r' + r'' = n - 2, \quad s + s' + s'' = n - 2, \quad t + t' + t'' = n - 2.$$

The augmentatives will thus be of the degree $2n-2$.

Furthermore, we must make $\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 2$. It will still be possible to satisfy by integer multipliers the equations

$$\begin{aligned} U &= x^\alpha F + y^\beta F' + z^\gamma F'', \\ V &= x^\alpha G + y^\beta G' + z^\gamma G'', \\ W &= x^\alpha H + y^\beta H' + z^\gamma H'', \end{aligned}$$

[these it will be useful in future to term the *equations*, x^α , y^β , z^γ being the *arguments*, and F, G, H , &c. the *factors* of decomposition] for otherwise calling

⁴Vide page 76 for the Latin version.

the indices of x, y, z in any original argument a, b, c , their sum or n would be not greater than $(n + 2) - 3$, that is $(n - 1)$, which is absurd.

For the same reasons as in the last case no index of augmentation must be made zero: the degree of each will be $(n - \alpha) + (n - \beta) + (n - \gamma)$, that is $(2n - 2)$, and their number $\frac{(n + 1)n}{2}$; the number of augmentatives will be $3\frac{(n - 1)n}{2}$ linearly uninvolved, each of the degree $2n - 2$, and therefore containing $\frac{(2n - 1)2n}{2}$ arguments.

Now

$$\frac{(n + 1)n}{2} + 3\frac{(n - 1)n}{2} = \frac{(2n - 1)2n}{2}.$$

p. 80

Hence the final derivee may be found, and it will be in its lowest terms, for every member will contain $\frac{3(n - 1)n}{2}$ letters due to the augmentative, and $\frac{3(n + 1)n}{2}$ due to the partial derivative equations; in all then there will be $3n^2$ letters in each term.

This second method being applied to three quadratic equations of the most general form, leads to the problem of eliminating between six simple equations which lies within the limits of practical feasibility, and it is my intention to register the final derivee upon the pages of some one of our scientific Transactions as a standing monument for the guidance of hereafter coming explorers⁵.

SCHOLIUM TO CASE A.

If we attempt to carry forward these processes to quaternary systems, it becomes necessary to make

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma + \delta = (r - 2)n + 1$$

or else

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma + \delta = (r - 2)n + 2,$$

where r is the number of proposees.

Now if the factors in the equations of decomposition are all integer, one of the indices of derivation must be not greater than the corresponding index in any of the original arguments, which may easily be shown to be always impossible for a system of equations, complete in all their terms, whenever their number r is greater than three, if $\alpha + \beta + \gamma + \delta = (r - 2)n + 2$; but if $\alpha + \beta + \gamma + \delta = (r - 2)n + 1$ only possible for the case of $n = 2$.

⁵Elimination between *two* quadratics leads to a final derivee made up of *seven* terms only; the final derivee of *three* quadratics is made up of at least several *thousand*; nay, I believe I may safely say, several *myriads* of terms!

Let $U = 0, V = 0, W = 0, Z = 0$, be four quadratic equations existing between x, y, z, t .

Make

$$\begin{aligned} xU &= 0, & xV &= 0, & xW &= 0, & xZ &= 0, \\ yU &= 0, & yV &= 0, & yW &= 0, & yZ &= 0, \\ zU &= 0, & zV &= 0, & zW &= 0, & zZ &= 0, \\ tU &= 0, & tV &= 0, & tW &= 0, & tZ &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Also write

$$\begin{aligned} U &= x^2F + yF' + zF'' + tF''' = 0, \\ V &= x^2G + yG' + zG'' + tG''' = 0, \\ W &= x^2H + yH' + zH'' + tH''' = 0, \\ Z &= x^2K + yK' + zK'' + tK''' = 0. \end{aligned}$$

p. 81

By eliminating linearly we get

$$\Sigma\{F\Sigma G'(H''K''' - H'''K'')\} = 0,$$

which will be of the third degree, since the factors represented by the unmarked letters F, G, H, K are of zero, and all the rest of unit dimensions.

Similarly we may obtain other equations, so that besides the sixteen augmentatives already written down, we have four secondary derivatives, namely,

$$\Pi(2111) = 0, \quad \Pi(1211) = 0, \quad \Pi(1121) = 0, \quad \Pi(1112) = 0.$$

Thus we have twenty equations and as many arguments to eliminate, since a perfect cubic function of four letters contains twenty terms.

The final derivee will contain $16 + 4 \cdot 4$ letters, that is 32, 8 or 2^3 belonging to each system of original prefixes in each member, and will therefore be in its lowest terms: for one of the canons of form teaches us, *à priori*, that every member of the derivee deduced from any number of assumed equations must contain in each member as many prefixes belonging to one equation of the system as there are units in the product of the indices of all the rest taken together.

COROLLARY TO CASE A.

Either of the two methods given as applicable to this case enables us to determine integer values of X, Y, Z , which shall satisfy the equation

$$XU + YV + ZW = Fx^p y^q z^r,$$

where F is the final derivee and $p + q + r = 3n - 2$. For by the doctrine of simple equations we know how to express F in terms of the linear functions, out

of which it is obtained by permutation, that is we are able to assign values of A, B, C , and their antitypes, as also of L and its antitype, which shall satisfy the equation

$$\begin{aligned} \Sigma(Ax^r y^{r'} z^{r''} U) + \Sigma(Bx^s y^{s'} z^{s''} V) + \Sigma(Cx^t y^{t'} z^{t''} W) \\ + \Sigma\{L\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)\} = Fx^f y^g z^h, \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

where A, B, C , as well as L and all the quantities formed after them, are made up of integer combinations of the original prefixes.

Now the functions $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ may be expressed in three ways in terms of U, V, W , as has been already shown.

p. 82

We may therefore suppose these functions to be divided into three groups, and make

$$\Sigma L\Pi(\alpha\beta\gamma) = \Sigma \frac{QU + Q'V + Q''W}{x^\alpha} + \Sigma \frac{RU + R'V + R''W}{y^\beta} + \Sigma \frac{SU + S'V + S''W}{z^\gamma}. \quad (2)$$

And it is evident that the equations (1) and (2) lead immediately to the equation

$$XU + YV + ZW = Fx^{a+f} y^{b+g} z^{c+h},$$

if we call a, b, c the *greatest values* attributed respectively to α, β, γ .

Now if we suppose the first method to be followed,

$$f + g + h = 2n - 1.$$

And it will always be possible to make a, b, c of what values we please subject to the condition of $a + b + c = n - 1$; for *one* at least of the indices of derivation in $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ must be not greater than its correspondent among a, b, c ; otherwise $\alpha + \beta + \gamma$ would be not less than $(a + b + c) + 3$; but

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 1, \quad a + b + c = n - 1,$$

which is absurd.

Hence we can satisfy $XU + YV + ZW = Fx^p y^q z^r$, p, q, r being subject to the condition of $p + q + r = 3n - 2$, but otherwise arbitrary.

Moreover, we can *not* do so if $p + q + r$ be less than $3n - 2$, for that would require $a + b + c$ to be less than $n - 1$. Now if two of the indices of derivation, as α and β , be made equal to $a + 1, b + 1$ respectively, the third $\gamma = (n + 1) - (a + b + 2) = (n - 1) - (a + b)$, and is therefore greater than c : so that $\alpha + \beta + \gamma$ for this case becomes greater than $a + b + c$, and the method falls to the ground.

In fact, I have discovered a theorem which lets me know this, *à priori*, a law which serves as a staff to guide my feet from falling into error in devising linear methods of solution, and the importance of which all candid judges who

have studied the general theory of elimination cannot fail to recognize. To wit, if $X_1, X_2, X_3 \dots X_n$ be n integer complete polynomial functions of n letters $x_1, x_2 \dots x_n$, and severally of the degree $b_1, b_2, b_3 \dots b_n$; then it is always possible to satisfy the identity

$$P_1X_1 + P_2X_2 + P_3X_3 + \dots + P_nX_n = Fx_1^{a_1}x_2^{a_2}x_3^{a_3} \dots x_n^{a_n},$$

p. 83

if $a_1 + a_2 + a_3 + \dots + a_n$ be equal to or greater than $b_1 + b_2 + b_3 + \dots + b_n - n + 1$, but otherwise *not*⁶.

This again is founded immediately upon a simple proposition, of which I have obtained a very interesting and instructive demonstration, shortly to appear, and which may be enumerated thus: “*The number of augmentees of the same degree that can be formed, linearly independent of one another, out of any number of polynomial functions of as many variables, may be either equal to or less than the number of distinct arguments contained in such augmentees, but never greater. The latter will be the case when the index of the augmentees diminished by unity is less than the sum of the indices of the original unaugmented polynomials each so diminished; the former, when the aforesaid index is equal to or greater than the aforesaid sum.*”

To return to the particular case of finding X, Y, Z to satisfy

$$XU + YV + ZW = Fx^p y^q z^r.$$

This has been already done according to the first method; if we employ the *second* method of elimination we shall have

$$f + g + h = 2n - 2.$$

But, now since $\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 2$, we shall easily see by the same method as above, that the least value of $a + b + c$ {where a, b, c denote respectively the greatest values of α, β, γ , appearing in the denominator of the fractional forms used to express $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ }, will be one greater than before, or n ; so that $f + g + h + a + b + c$ will still be equal to $3n - 2$, as we might, *à priori*, by virtue of our rule, have been assured.

⁶Hence it is apparent, that in applying the method of multipliers, a curious and important distinction exists between the cases of there being two equations, and there being a greater number to eliminate from: for in the first case the element of arbitrariness needs never to appear; in the latter it cannot possibly be excluded from appearing in the multipliers.

This will explain how it comes to pass that the method of the text may be employed to give *various* solutions of the $XU + YV + ZW = Fx^p y^q z^r$; thus not only can p, q and r be variously made up of $(f + a), (g + b), (h + c)$, but also $\Pi(\alpha, \beta, \gamma)$ when two of the indices (α, β) suppose are each not greater than the assigned greatest values a, b may be made to figure indifferently either under the form

$$\frac{\lambda U + \mu V + \nu W}{x^\alpha} \quad \text{or that of} \quad \frac{\lambda' U + \mu' V + \nu' W}{y^\beta}.$$

TERNARY SYSTEMS.

CASE B. TWO OF THE INDICES EQUAL; THE THIRD LESS BY A UNIT.

Let $U = 0, V = 0, W = 0$, be the three given equations severally of the degree $n, n, (n - 1)$. p. 84

Make

$$r + r' + r'' = n - 2, \quad s + s' + s'' = n - 2, \quad t + t' + t'' = n - 1,$$

by multiplying U into $x^r y^{r'} z^{r''}$, V into $x^s y^{s'} z^{s''}$, W into $x^t y^{t'} z^{t''}$, we obtain augmentees each of the same, namely, the $(2n - 2)$ th degree.

The number of these is

$$\frac{(n - 1)n}{2} + \frac{(n - 1)n}{2} + \frac{n(n + 1)}{2}.$$

Again, make

$$\alpha + \beta + \gamma = n + 1.$$

It will still be possible, as before, to form equations of decomposition in which $x^\alpha, y^\beta, z^\gamma$ are the arguments, and affected with integer factors. For if we look to W even, all its arguments are of the form $x^a y^b z^c$, where $a + b + c = (n - 1)$, and each of these cannot be less than its correspondent, for that would be to say that $(n - 1)$ is not greater $(n + 1) - 3$, *à fortiori*, U and V can be decomposed in the manner described. Thus, then, we shall obtain as many secondary derivees as in the last case (Method 1), that is, $\frac{n(n - 1)}{2}$ {since $\alpha + \beta + \gamma$ is still equal to $(n + 1)$ }, as before. Moreover, each of these will be of $(n - \alpha) + (n - \beta) + (n - 1 - \gamma)$, that is of $2n - 2$ dimensions.

Altogether, therefore, we have

$$\left\{ \frac{(n - 1)n}{2} + \frac{(n - 1)n}{2} + \frac{n(n + 1)}{2} \right\} + \frac{(n - 1)n}{2}$$

linear independent equations of the degree $2n - 2$, and the number of arguments to eliminate is $\frac{(2n - 1)2n}{2}$. Now these two numbers are equal.

Thus we obtain a final derivee containing of U 's coefficients $\frac{(n - 1)n}{2} + \frac{(n - 1)n}{2}$, an equal number of V 's, but of W 's $\frac{n(n + 1)}{2} + \frac{(n - 1)n}{2}$; now $n(n - 1)$, $n(n - 1)$ and n^2 exactly express the number that ought to appear of each of these respectively: hence the final derivee is clear of *irrelevant factors*.

TERNARY SYSTEMS.

CASE C. TWO OF THE INDICES EQUAL; THE THIRD ONE GREATER BY A UNIT.

Here, calling n the highest index, the augmentees must each be made of the degree $(2n - 3)$, their number will evidently be

$$\frac{(n-2)(n-1)}{2} + \frac{(n-1)n}{2} + \frac{(n-1)n}{2},$$

making the sum of the indices of derivation now, as before, equal to $(n + 1)$; it will be still possible to form integer equations of decomposition, which will give rise to augmentatives of the degree $(n - \alpha) + (n - 1) - \beta + (n - 1) - \gamma$, that is, of $(2n - 3)$ dimensions. The total number of equations, what with augmentatives and secondary derivatives, will be

$$\left\{ \frac{(n-2)(n-1)}{2} + \frac{(n-1)n}{2} + \frac{(n-1)n}{2} \right\} + \frac{n(n-1)}{2} \\ = \frac{4n^2 - 4n + 2}{2} = \frac{(2n-2)(2n-1)}{2},$$

that is, is equal to the exact number of distinct arguments contained between them.

Also the final derivative will contain in each member

$$\frac{(n-2)(n-1)}{2} + \frac{n(n-1)}{2},$$

that is, $(n-1)(n-1)$, letters belonging to the first equation, and

$$\frac{(n-1)n}{2} + \frac{n(n-1)}{2},$$

that is, $n(n-1)$ belonging to those of the second and of the third, and will therefore be in its *lowest terms*.

COROLLARY TO CASES B AND C.

It is not necessary, after all that has been already said, to do more than just point out that the processes applicable to these cases enable us to determine X, Y, Z , which satisfy the equation

$$XU + YV + ZW = Fx^f y^g z^h,$$

where

$$f + g + h = 3n - 3 \quad \text{for Case B,}$$

and

$$f + g + h = 3n - 4 \quad \text{for Case C.}$$

16.

MEMOIR ON THE DIALYTIC METHOD OF ELIMINATION. PART I

[*Philosophical Magazine*, XXI. (1842), pp. 534–539; reprinted from *Proc. Roy. Irish Acad.*, Vol. II. (1840–1844), p. 130]

p. 86

The author confines himself in this part to the treatment of two equations, the final and other derivees of which form the subject of investigation.

The author was led to reconsider his former labours in this department of the general theory by finding certain results announced by M. Cauchy in *L'Institut*, March Number of the present year, which flow as obvious and immediate consequences from Mr Sylvester's own previously published principles and method.

Let there be two equations in x ,

$$\begin{aligned} U &= ax^n + bx^{n-1} + cx^{n-2} + ex^{n-3} + \&c. = 0, \\ V &= \alpha x^m + \beta x^{m-1} + \gamma x^{m-2} + \&c. = 0, \end{aligned}$$

and let $n = m + \iota$, where ι is zero or any positive value (as may be).

Let any such quantities as $x^r U$, $x^s V$, be termed augmentatives of U or V .

To obtain the derivee of a degree s units lower than V , we must join s augmentatives of U with $s + \iota$ of V . Then out of $2s + \iota$ equations

$$\begin{aligned} x^0 U &= 0, & x^1 U &= 0, & x^2 U &= 0, & \dots & x^{s-1} U &= 0, \\ x^0 V &= 0, & x^1 V &= 0, & x^2 V &= 0, & \dots & x^{\iota+s-1} V &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

we may eliminate linearly $2s + \iota - 1$ quantities.

Now these equations contain no power of x higher than $m + \iota + s - 1$; accordingly, all powers of x , superior to $m - s$, may be eliminated, and the derivee of the degree $(m - s)$ obtained in its prime form.

Thus to obtain the final derivee (which is the derivee of the degree zero), we take m augmentatives of U with n of V , and eliminate $(m + n - 1)$ quantities, namely,

$$x, \quad x^2, x^3, \dots \text{ up to } x^{m+n-1}.$$

p. 87

This process, founded upon the dialytic principle, admits of a very simple modification. Let us begin with the case where $\iota = 0$, or $m = n$. Let the augmentatives of U be termed $U_0, U_1, U_2, U_3, \dots$ and of V , $V_0, V_1, V_2, V_3, \dots$, the equations themselves being written

$$\begin{aligned} U &= ax^n + bx^{n-1} + cx^{n-2} + \&c. \\ V &= a'x^n + b'x^{n-1} + c'x^{n-2} + \&c. \end{aligned}$$

It will readily be seen that

$$\begin{aligned} & a'U_0 - aV_0, \\ & (b'U_0 - bV_0) + (a'U_1 - aV_1), \\ & (c'U_0 - cV_0) + (b'U_1 - bV_1) + (a'U_2 - aV_2), \text{ \&c.} \end{aligned}$$

will be each linearly independent functions of $x, x^2, \dots x^{m-1}$, no higher power of x remaining. Whence it follows, that to obtain a derivate of the degree $(m - s)$ in its prime form, we have only to employ the s of those which occur first in order, and amongst them eliminate $x^{m-1}, x^{m-2}, \dots x^{m-s+1}$. Thus, to obtain the *final* derivate, we must make use of n , that is, the entire number of them.

Now, let us suppose that ι is not zero, but $m = n - \iota$. The equation V may be conceived to be of n instead of m dimensions, if we write it under the form

$$0x^n + 0x^{n-1} + 0x^{n-2} + \dots + 0x^{m+1} + \alpha x^m + \beta x^{m-1} + \text{\&c.} = 0,$$

and we are able to apply the same method as above; but as the first ι of the coefficients in the equation above written are zero, the first ι of the quantities

$$(a'U_0 - aV_0), \quad (b'U_0 - bV_0) + (a'U_1 - aV_1), \quad \text{\&c.}$$

may be read simply

$$-aV_0, \quad -bV_0 - aV_1, \quad -cV_0 - bV_1 - aV_2, \quad \text{\&c.}$$

and evidently their office can be supplied by the simple augmentatives themselves,

$$V_0 = 0, \quad V_1 = 0, \quad V_2 = 0 \dots V_{l-1} = 0;$$

and thus ι letters, which otherwise would be *irrelevant*, fall out of the several derivees.

The author then proceeds with remarks upon the general theory of simple equations, and shows how by virtue of that theory his method contains a solution of the identity

$$X_r U + Y_r V = D_r,$$

where D_r is a derivate of the r th degree of U and V , and accordingly, X_r of the form

$$\lambda + \mu x + \nu x^2 + \dots + \theta x^{m-r-1},$$

and Y_r of the form

$$l + mx + \dots + tx^{n-r-1},$$

p. 88

and accounts *à priori* for the fact of not more than $(n - r)$ simple equations being required for the determination of the $(m + n - 2r)$ quantities λ, μ, ν , &c. l, m, n , &c., by exhibiting these latter as *known* linear functions of no more than $(n - r)$ unknown quantities left to be determined.

Upon this remarkable relation may be constructed a method well adapted for the expeditious computation of numerical values of the different derivees.

He next, as a point of curiosity, exhibits the values of the secondary functions,

$$\begin{aligned} & a'U_0 - aV_0, \\ & b'U_0 - bV_0 + a'U_1 - aV_1, \\ & c'U_0 - cV_0 + b'U_1 - bV_1 + a'U_2 - aV_2, \quad \&c. \end{aligned}$$

under the form of symmetric functions of the roots of the equations $U = 0$, $V = 0$, by aid of the theorems developed in the London and Edinburgh *Philosophical Magazine*, December 1839⁷, and afterwards proceeds to a more close examination of the final derivee resulting from two equations each of the same (any given) degree.

He conceives a number of cubic blocks each of which has two numbers, termed its characteristics, inscribed upon one of its faces, upon which the value of such a block (itself called an *element*) depends.

For instance, the value of the *element*, whose characteristics are r, s , is the difference between two products: the one of the coefficient r th in order occurring in the polynomial U , by that which comes s th in order in V ; the other product is that of the coefficient s th in order of the polynomial U , by that r th in order of V ; so that if the degree of each equation be n , there will be altogether $\frac{1}{2}n(n+1)$ such elements.

The blocks are formed into squares or flats (*plafonds*) of which the number is $\frac{n}{2}$ or $\frac{n+1}{2}$, according as n is even or odd. The first of these contains n blanks in a side, the next $(n-2)$, the next $(n-4)$, till finally we reach a square of four blocks or of one, according as n is even or odd. These flats are laid upon one another so as to form a regularly ascending pyramid, of which the two diagonal planes are termed the planes of separation and symmetry respectively. The former divides the pyramid into two halves, such that no element on the one side of it is the same as that of any block in the other. The plane of symmetry, as the name denotes, divides the pyramid into two exactly *similar* parts; it being a rule, that *all elements lying in any given line of a square (plafond) parallel to the plane of separation are identical*; moreover, the sum of the characteristics is the same, for *all elements lying anywhere in a plane* parallel to that of separation. p. 89

All the terms in the final derivee are made up by multiplying n elements of the pile together, under the sole restriction, that no two or more terms of the said product shall lie in any one plane out of the two sets of planes perpendicular to the sides of the squares. The *sign* of any such product is determined by the places of either set of planes parallel to a side of the squares and to one another, in which the elements composing it may be conceived to lie.

⁷p. 40 above. ED.

The author then enters into a disquisition relating to the *number* of terms which will appear in the final derieve, and concludes this first part with the statement of two general canons, each of which affords as many tests for determining whether a prepared combination of coefficients can enter into the final derieve of any number of equations as there are units in that number, but so connected as together only to afford double that number, less one, of independent conditions.

The first of these canons refers simply to the number of letters drawn out of *each of the given equations* (supposed homogeneous); the second to what he proposes to call the *weight* of every term in the derieve in respect to *each of the variables* which are to be eliminated.

The author subjoins, for the purpose of conveying a more accurate conception of his Pyramid of derivation, examples of the mode in which it is constructed.

When $n = 2$ there is one flat, viz.

When $n = 1$ there is one flat, viz.

1, 2

2, 3	2, 4
2, 4	3, 4

Let $n = 3$, there will be two flats:

Let $n = 4$, there will still be two flats only:

2, 3

1, 2	1, 3	1, 4
1, 3	1, 4	2, 4
1, 4	2, 4	3, 4

2, 3	2, 4
2, 4	3, 4

1, 2	1, 3	1, 4	1, 5
1, 3	1, 4	1, 5	2, 5
1, 4	1, 5	2, 5	3, 5
1, 5	2, 5	3, 5	4, 5

Let $n = 5$, there will be three flats:

p. 90

3, 4	2, 3	2, 4	2, 5		
	2, 4	2, 5	3, 5		
	2, 5	3, 5	4, 5		
	1, 2	1, 3	1, 4	1, 5	1, 6
	1, 3	1, 4	1, 5	1, 6	2, 6
	1, 4	1, 5	1, 6	2, 6	3, 6
	1, 5	1, 6	2, 6	3, 6	4, 6
	1, 6	2, 6	3, 6	4, 6	5, 6

Let $n = 6$, there will be three flats:

3, 4	3, 5	2, 3	2, 4	2, 5	2, 6
3, 5	4, 5	2, 4	2, 5	2, 6	3, 6
		2, 5	2, 6	3, 6	4, 6
		2, 6	3, 6	4, 6	5, 6

1, 2	1, 3	1, 4	1, 5	1, 6	1, 7
1, 3	1, 4	1, 5	1, 6	1, 7	2, 7
1, 4	1, 5	1, 6	1, 7	2, 7	3, 7
1, 5	1, 6	1, 7	2, 7	3, 7	4, 7
1, 6	1, 7	2, 7	3, 7	4, 7	5, 7
1, 7	2, 7	3, 7	4, 7	5, 7	6, 7

Thus the work of computation reduces itself merely to calculating $n\frac{n+1}{2}$ elements, or the $n(n+1)$ cross-products out of which they are constituted, and combining them factorially after that law of the pyramid, to which allusion has been already made.